figure in the twenty-six top exporting countries listed. It was the same in 1983.

In 1980, India's global exports at $5.9 billion, of total exports of $1.97 trillion, gave us a share of only 0.3 per cent. The country was almost closed to the world in terms of trade as our imports at $12.6 billion were also only 0.63 per cent of total global imports of $2.01 trillion. India's share of global trade (imports and exports together) was $18.5 billion of the total trade of $3.98 trillion, a share of just 0.46 per cent. In terms of share of exports of goods and services as a percentage of GDP, India's performance was the worst in 1965, when the exports of goods and services as a proportion of GDP amounted to only 3.31 per cent. The country had a very small rise in share of exports of goods and services to GDP until 1991, when it was 7.05 per cent. After liberalization, exports took off and rose to the highest exports of goods and services to the GDP ratio of 25.43 per cent in 2013. Again, it has been falling steadily since then and reached only 18.4 per cent in 2019.

Trade Self-Reliance is Usually Disguised Trade Nationalism

No human being, household, village, city or state in India can produce the goods and services needed for sustenance and consumption by itself. This was extremely difficult even in the pre-agricultural period when people lived in tribes. It is impossible in the modern era of specialization and technological and economic integration. Further, if everyone could produce and consume all goods and services, there would be no income generation to buy from anyone else. Such a world is nothing but a chimera.

The same rationale applies to sovereign nations as well. No nation can hope to produce all the goods and services needed for the consumption and welfare of its people. Nations are endowed with different natural resources. For instance, India is deficient in energy fuels and has to import them for growth and development. Differences in skill endowments and abilities